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The Yale Political Quarterly

An Undergraduate Publication

VOLUME 20, NUMBER 4, APRIL 1999

TWENTI ETH  ANNIVERSARY

Michele Kennedy

The Demise of Apartheid? A Critique of U.S. Foreign Policy

J.T. Davis

The Politics of Western Hemispheric Integration

Ari Holtzblatt

Book Review:

The New Political Culture

eds. Terry Clark, Vincent Hoffman-Martinot

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THE YALE POLITICAL QUARTERLY

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4 **Unburdening Apartheid's Legacy**
Michele Kennedy

In the first of our focus on US foreign policy articles, the author presents a close analysis of South Africa's tumultuous record on human rights. In parallel, she critiques the international community's (and particularly the US's) responsibility to encourage democratization and stable transition.

8 **The Politics of Western Hemispheric Integration**
J.T. Davis

J.T. Davis, Adjunct Instructor of Political Science and History at Vincennes University and a former faculty member at the US Army School of the Americas, discusses US foreign policy in Latin America.

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Is Apartheid Truly Dead?

Michele Kennedy

The situation of today's South Africa is quite precarious, and the stability and success of its leadership remains to be determined. The nation is currently functioning on a fine line between the old system of racist elitism and a new one of democratic and legitimate rule; a reconciliatory balance has not yet been found. Recent changes in the small country, however, have triggered one of the world's most drastically altered stances toward human rights, from a completely racist disregard for such rights to a celebration of human integrity and universal capability. The new democratic leaders have embraced these values, but the actual implementation of policies in accordance with them is questionable. Fragmentation within the government has made South Africa's hold on democracy a tenuous one, which would be fortified by more consistent external support. Perhaps the international community underestimates its influence on such a promising cause, for such support or lack thereof may determine whether the dreaded apartheid system ends or is reborn. There is much to be learned from this small yet tenacious nation, and its example may prove it to be a pioneer of autonomy in the African continent if the aforementioned balance is tipped in constructive directions.

The apartheid system stems from deeply entrenched patterns of historical discrimination in South Africa. The residue of colonialism has stubbornly persisted throughout the twentieth century, and was especially vivified by the international scope of World War II. In the aftermath of the war, South African-produced military exports to Western Allies were in high demand. The resulting expanded production triggered several changes, among them a marked urbanization and an increased prominence of skilled labor. Despite the apparent promise in such changes, there were instead several draconian apartheid measures invoked to counteract urban bloating. Among them was the Bantu Laws Amendment Act (1964) which allowed the government to expel an African from any "white" town or farming area.[1] Another example was the Extension of University Education Act (1959) which made it virtually impossible for Africans to enroll in college, a major incentive for moving to larger urban centers. Among the destructive consequences of these policies were violent movements and protests on an international scale. The most famous instance was the 1960 Sharpeville massacre, during which 178 injuries and 69 deaths resulted from a police attack on a womens' rights

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demonstration. The international community was horrified and, consequently, there were numerous boycotts, strikes and protests by foreign anti-apartheid forces.

Similar movements against apartheid measures continued over the next few decades, even though draconian restrictions on the South African media muted and censored coverage of much of the repressive government activity. Amidst all of the friction and apparent stagnation, there were some promising causes that grew out of the opposition. For instance, despite the discriminating labor laws, a strong trade union movement and heightened consciousness emerged from the urban African population of the 1940s. This growing sentiment produced both the South African Communist Party (SACP) and the African National Congress (ANC), of which the latter would prove to be a tenacious democratic force later in the century.

Indeed, it was the ANC that brought new verve to the South African political scene and began, at long last, to tip the system in favor of democracy. The nation's first democratic elections took place in April of 1994 and Nelson Mandela of the ANC was elected President. Subsequently, in 1995 and 1996, free and fair local elections were held and widely appealing legitimate branches of local government began to form. A landmark of the new leadership was the South African Constitution, which was signed by President Mandela on International Human Rights Day and finally adopted on May 8, 1996, a celebratory occasion for those who had awaited the end of apartheid for so many years.

This significant democratic step brought about a vital question: could the new government really destroy apartheid? Mandela's platform and the post-1994 ANC agenda, solidifying themselves against a history of racist policies, presented an ideological picture of egalitarianism and universal human rights. Subsequent policy trends, however, have revealed a conditional stance with regard to these ideals. The current scenario of arms sales demonstrates this erratic governmental trend, for South Africa has initiated trade with several countries with marred human rights records. In September of 1996, for instance, arms sales with Rwanda were approved despite the prominence of genocide in that nation. The status of South African leadership was brought into question, and several human rights groups, local and international, vehemently opposed the decision. After extensive pressure from such groups, in addition to a condemnation from Amnesty International, the government stopped all sales with Rwanda in July 1997.[2]

Conversely, there have been some political decisions made very much in accordance with declared ideals, such as interaction with Turkey in mid-1995. South African leadership blocked a potentially profitable sale of attack helicopters to Turkey because of the country's occupation of part of Cyprus – a violation of international law – and its continued human rights abuse of its Kurdish minority population. "The decision, according to the government's National Conventional Arms Control Committee, was proof that South Africa was trying to find a realistic formula for balancing its trade, diplomatic, and security interests. The decision to block arms sales to Turkey was widely applauded in South Africa, but it also reflected the government's uncertain approach to complex foreign policy issues." The contrasting motivations for the decisions toward Rwanda and Turkey illustrate an inconsistent dedication to democratic ideals. However, both internal and external human rights groups and non-governmental organizations closely monitor government responsibility to ensure a lack of discrimination. Its lingering threatens to undermine all of the democratic progress made in the past decade.

A blaring obstacle impeding constructive reform has been fragmentation within the new South African leadership. This polarization was exacerbated by the vicious murder of Sofiso Nkabinde, the young leader of the United Democratic Movement party (UDM), on January 23 of this year.[3] Though Nkabinde assisted the ANC in the first couple years after the new constitution was adopted, he was accused of spying in 1997 and was therefore fired from the ruling party. Consequently, many automatically associated his

Could the new government really destroy apartheid?

murder with the ANC, and there were several protests including a massacre of 11 people in the home of an ANC official. The murder and the resulting war between the ANC and the UDM could not have been more untimely, for South Africa's second democratic elections are imminent and democracy is precarious.

Another related concern is that of the unchallenged rule of the ANC which, "as it grows less tolerant of opposition, is growing more so of bungling and bribe-trousering."[4] Nevertheless, many constructive reforms have been implemented since the dawning of democracy to prove the authentic dedication of the party to political improvement. Mandela promised to hire black politicians in jobs once reserved for whites, but also clearly stated that qualifications would remain high. In practice, however, the government often hires blacks without much consideration of competence, and the education system remains weak and therefore cannot begin to solve the problem of lack of qualification. In fact, fewer blacks graduate from high school now than did under apartheid! Additionally, while the wages of the black elite have drastically increased, most unskilled blacks remain destitute. Thus, financial polarization, fragmentation and inconsistency have marred the democratic ideals of the ruling party.

It does seem odd, at first glance, to observe South Africa apparently contradict the overthrowing of apartheid by choosing weak leaders, neglecting the education system and indirectly permitting human rights abuse through policy choices. There is also some hypocrisy involved in such a critique, for the United States has been less than consistent in its internal and external support of democratic ideals and egalitarianism. It is easy to ignore distant injustice when domestic affairs are running relatively smoothly; how much can ruthless genocide or religious warfare really hit home when we watch them on our third television set in the comfort of our domestic lives? Perhaps it is a universal human flaw that we cannot fathom violent hatred unless it is at our doorstep, but is it fair to expect that kind of empathy from South Africa when we are a nation plagued with apathy? Their new leadership has implemented numerous anti-racist and democratic policies, which certainly show a humanistic concern, but have not yet assured the consistency of an established political regime. Our double standards and transparent "support" could politically excuse the U.S., subtly and sneakily, from assisting South Africa, or we could demonstrate our commitment to democracy by creating genuine and tangible alliances. This jointly constructed backbone to their fragile leadership would not only encourage ideologically and democratically consistent South African political life, but would also help to shrink our own ideological-versus-actual gap.

The decision between political apathy and helpful action with regard to South Africa is by no means unique to the United States, but rather is a choice to be made by the international community at large. The constructive effects of external support for this new democracy have been underestimated and their implementation limited, or at best, conditional. Motivation for political outreach has been mixed, as is illustrated by two bills currently pending in the House of Representatives. The "African Growth and Opportunity" Act (H.R. 434), which Mandela disapproves of, makes it easier for foreign corporations to gain control of African resources.[5] Many aspects of the bill advocate the desires of the IMF – an ironic twist given the unsuccessful record of IMF performance in the region. Called the NAFTA of Africa, this bill caters to foreign capitalists and investors before the more immediate needs of Africans. In contrast, the Human Rights, Opportunity, Partnership and Empowerment (HOPE) for Africa Act (H.R. 772) was created by legislators, civil society groups and economists from both the U.S. and Africa. The act "adopts a holistic ap-

The constructive effects of external support for this new democracy have been underestimated and their implementation limited, or at best, conditional.

proach to the elements essential to ensuring a mutually successful U.S. – sub-Saharan Africa economic policy, including business facilitation, aid, debt relief, and AIDS treatment and prevention. The legislation enjoys broad support of African labor, environmental and development organizations, as well as their U.S. counterparts." The HOPE for Africa Act, unlike H.R. 434, initiates a reciprocal and respectful alliance between the U.S. and Africa and illustrates the type of foreign policy approach that would be most constructive for South Africa's new democracy.

The conditional nature of foreign support evokes a crucial question: why would nations that claim to be progressively democratic forsake a country of the developing world during its most crucial steps toward democracy? A cynical and tragically accurate answer would be that support from the "developed world" is more capitalistic than humanistic, and is also very conditional. Though South Africa is potentially a great economic ally, financial boom is quite premature right now. It would still make sense, however, for industrialized countries to encourage growth in such a promising nation, but instead political action and media attention have largely ignored South African issues. This avoidance seems highly ironic in an age that idealizes the picture of a developing nation transforming into a democratic and successfully capitalistic country, especially in light of global integration. Perhaps South Africa brings the hypocrisy of the developed world too close to home, and we are not ready to acknowledge nor to confront our own discrimination issues, human rights discrepancies, financial polarization and lack of authentic democracy. The time has come for us to treat South Africa as a capable and respectable nation in its efforts to establish a viable democracy, and, in turn, to assert our devotion to our professed democratic ideals.

[1] African National Congress Homepage: <http://www.anc.org.za/>.

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US State Department Managing of the Political Economy 1994-1998: The Sources of Western Hemispheric Integration

J. T. Davis

Fiscal Background

Traditionally, Western Economists have debated interventionist monetary decisions within this Hemisphere. They generally agree that the current US market is efficient and dynamic regarding macro-economic inter-regional trade. The use of comparative advantage to justify complicity in these transactions may be suspect with regard to Hemispheric utility. Though history has favored the Northern region in the pursuit of maximizing profits, the Southern region has entered the epoch of realizing the potential for gains in this regard. Given the "Win-Win" objectives of the Latin American monetary decision-makers, there is a need for clarity concerning U.S. foreign policy objectives. Without definitive and cooperative roles in this economic process, the possibility of inter-regional political impasse may arise.

This role should begin with the recognition of consistency and perspective in the U.S. Department of State, Bureau of Inter-American Affairs (Snow & Brown: 1995). This institution is the primary facilitator, the "hands-on" worker of U.S. Foreign Policy, by design and purpose. Although its efficiency and effectiveness have been questioned, there should be clarity in the trend of in-complicity regarding the U.S. Legislative Authority which ratifies the conclusion of economic policy. For this reason, an evaluation of these two branches is important. It is also important to account for the Latin American leadership perspective and objective concerning this economic relationship. The goal of such a composite evaluation is to assess the direction of U.S. economic policy in the Western Hemisphere, specifically regarding the Latin American region.

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Monetary Direction

A significant factor in the election of President Bill Clinton in 1992, was the domestic effect of a global recession. In 1993 the actions of the Executive resulted in appointments directed towards the establishment of an Economic Council and later the December Economic Summit in Little Rock, Arkansas. During the first year of his Presidency, the Chief Executive realized that the term "intermestic," noting the close ties be-

tween international and domestic economic affairs, governs the dynamic nature of the globalization process. Moreover, recognition of continued leadership and solidarity among the G8 Countries became a necessity.

According to Donald Snow and Eugene Brown, the results of the Little Rock Summit closely followed the recommendations presented in the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace-Institute for International Economics' "Special Report: Policy Making for a New Era." The three themes were Economic Competitiveness, Emphasis on High Technology, and Industrial Policy. The first of these themes acknowledged intermestic weakness regarding competition in the areas of production, education, and intellectual capital. The second was related to the same category of weakness concerning research and development, commercialization, and services. It connects to the first in the context of prolific knowledge generation. The third theme dealt with corporate collaboration concerning academic sources of R&D, which generally means a pooling of resources. At this point in the economic cycle, the Summit determined the need for monetary intervention, actualizing in the form of tax incentives for complying corporations. This included research funding for specified areas to increase competition. The Department of Energy and the Environmental Protection Agency would be the focal point of coordination concerning research findings.

Clarity and direction were evident after the Little Rock as these themes were generally aimed at the industrialized countries of the world. It is necessary to be comprehensive when evaluating the thematic relationship between unity and competition where it is applied to Latin America as a developing region. Circumspection reveals the economic strategy of dynamism in the Democratization, Liberalization and Integration (DLI) process that is all too obvious to scholars of politics, history and communication. This is demonstrated by theories such as the Heckscher-Ohlin-Samuelson model of international trade. Theories similar to this one have whittled traditional notions of economic rationalism to the point of desperation. They have also threatened the U.S. ability to control the dynamism of the DLI process. This desperation and threat concern the perception of U.S. declining influence in the global economy. On the Hill, this concern takes the form of reorganizing the diplomatic tools of the Executive Branch: the Department of State is one of those tools.

US State Department Strategy

Warren Christopher directed the Department of State reorganization effort. He held the position of Secretary of State until 1997. Madeline Albright continues this process to date. The process streamlines the institution into five interconnecting departments that reflect the issues of the Globalization process in the 1990's:

1. Management
2. Arms Control and International Security
3. Global Affairs
4. Economics, Business and Agriculture
5. Political Affairs

The idea is to create a more flexible and responsive agency capable of implementing Executive foreign policy. The Department of Political Affairs deals with the implementation of that policy toward foreign regions. In the summer of 1998, the Bureau of Inter-American Affairs changed to the Bureau of Western Hemispheric Affairs. Jerry Rubin's announcement, regarding this event, mentions extensive negotiations with Canadian officials due to the implied intention of economic refocus. This is indicated by the strong reference to North American Free Trade Agreement (NAFTA), the Santiago Summit of the Americas and the Free Trade Area of the Americas (FTAA).

The strength of the reference lies with Canada's part in the Democratization, Liberation and Integration process. The history of political dynamics (U.S. and Latin America) regionally and the acknowledged shift concerning influence (Asia and E.U.) suggest North American collaboration to control this trend (Watson: 1994) (Economist: 14 Dec 1994). Examples are Canada's membership in NAFTA and its trade treaty with Chile. Chile is a perspective member of NAFTA and MERCOSUR. Canada has co-chairmanship in the Summit Implementation Review Group (SIRG) and is hosting the 1999 Santiago Summit. It is also hosting the current assembly of the Organi-

zation of the American States. It is expecting Chairmanship for the FTAA. These events strongly suggest a vision of united North American effort to organize a regional economic bloc. Further mention of strengthening the G8 alliance is significant because the speech was press released internationally.

Integration Dynamics

A dynamic hemispheric structure is possible with the successful implementation of a functional integration led by North America. The strategy is consistent with Mansfield's theory of inter-actor relationship dynamics. The inference is the continuance of North American dominance concerning monetary influence in hemispheric affairs. This may reveal a United States commitment to continue a dominant relationship with Latin America in the context of political economy.

This observation is realized with the creation of the new Bureau of Western Hemispheric Affairs. The Bureau's adaptations of vision include the themes of the Little Rock Summit and the Latin American inter-regional issues of Democratization, Liberation and Integration. These issues point in the general hemispheric direction of macroeconomic intervention. In regard to the issue of clarity, it is important to note that individual perspective is perhaps the weakest analytical link in the conveyance of vision. Political actor behavior is a complicated dependent variable arguably at any level of analysis. This is a sensitive consideration in decision-making, when actors measure each others' intent in diplomatic interface. When issues increase in number and their importance intensifies, in any given situation, a critical point of communication should be identified. When there is a change at these critical points of communication, it is important that the message conveyed be relevant and clear. This observation has merit in the evaluation of the Assistant Secretaries of State for the Bureaus of Inter-American and Western Hemispheric Affairs. The people who occupy these postings have the greatest opportunity to shape regional affairs. Their positions intervene at these critical points of communication in hemispheric monetary decision-making. It is at these points of intervention that the vision of Democratization, Liberation and Integration are in need of vision. Robert B. Textor, in Paul Bohannan's book, *How Culture Works*, notes the political importance of vision in policy making. He has concluded that any determination to structure a political future depends upon the importance placed on vision in this regard. Assistant Secretaries of State for the Bureaus of Inter-American and Western Hemispheric Affairs are the salesmen of vision to the U.S. Legislature and the Latin Regional Leadership. Moreover, the sale must clearly outline the commodity of DLI to these pivotal actors of the political economic process. The men who hold these positions have the opportunity to influence the economic direction of the Western Hemisphere. Their names are Alexander F. Watson, Jeffrey Davidow and Peter Romero. How effective were they? How effective are they? The most significant events that provide the answers to these questions begin with the 1994 Miami Summit of the Americas. They continue with the evolution of NAFTA and the regional support of FTAA (2005). The diplomatic work in preparation for the Santiago Summit of the Americas will be significant in the realization of the latter program. What have these Assistant Secretaries of State acted upon to effect the regional state of affairs?

Conclusion

These representatives of the State Department have affected the state of affairs concerning the hemispheric integration process. A medium for studying this effect is the speeches that they have made. Special note should be taken regarding who the audiences were and when the speeches were made. A comparison should be made to evaluate substantive responses to or reactions to events that would potentially affect US Policy. These Assistant Secretaries of State have delivered over twenty documented speeches that are consistent with this observation.

Alexander George is correct in his assessment concerning the accuracy of political analysis in the present decade: actor-specific behavioral models should replace the rational models used during the Cold War period. He is also correct in his suggestion that the knowledge and

judgement of specialists is important regarding the implementation of foreign policy. Pertti Alasuutari validates the political reality of the speech through his qualitative analytical methodology of rhetoric. Politically diplomatic rhetoric amounts to action in the sense that it produces a state of affairs when originated from governmental sources. The significance of this concept, applied to a market economy is evident to the scholar of modern fiscal process. This assessment necessitates the inclusion of situation during the process of observation and analysis.

Clearly, the observation and analysis of political, actor specific communication has merit concerning the assessment of monetary issues. The scholar who decides to apply this method to the questions this article has raised will encounter some very interesting qualitative postulations and conclusions. From 1994-1998, trends and patterns of political behavior are revealed and established concerning the US State Department, the Congress, Asian, European and Latin American involvement in the Western Hemispheric integration process. The policies of Democratization and Liberalization, when applied under these circumstances, reveal a pattern of Convergence and Divergence (See Figures 1, 1a and 1b). The audience and the timeliness of the speech establish the critical points of political and economic influence proven necessary to continue the US policy and strategy of the integration process. The importance of such a study is significant. It provides an opportunity for decision-makers to dismiss or include a different orientation to pursue the accurate understanding of the political economy in the Western Hemisphere.

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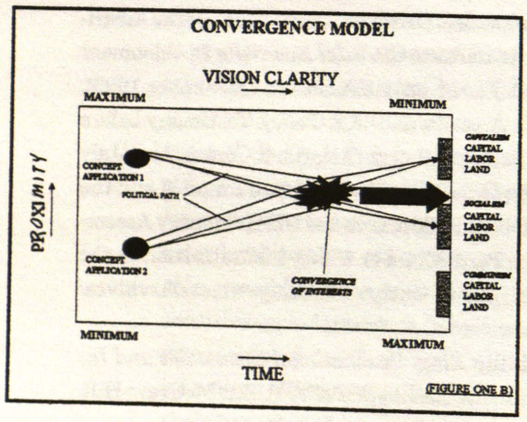
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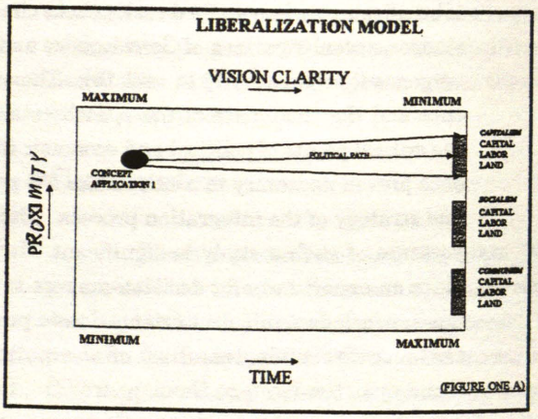
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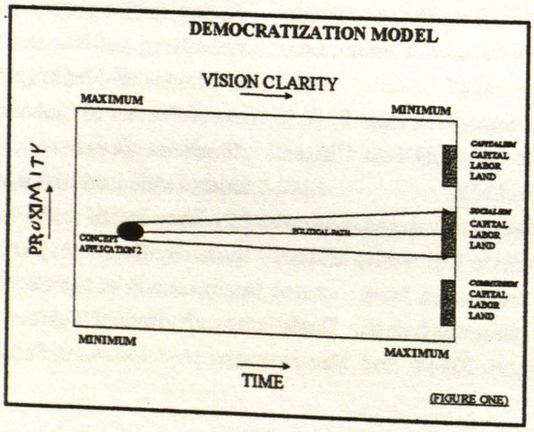
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-Book Review-

Moving To the Center

Ari Holtzblatt

The New Political Culture
edited by Terry Nichols Clark and Vincent Hoffmann-Martinot
Westview Press, 1998
298 pp., $26.95

Irrespective of one's opinion of Clinton's policies or effectiveness, it is generally agreed that he is one of the major progenitors of a new attitude towards political enterprise. Prime Minister Tony Blair, the leader of New Labor in England, Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu in Israel, former Massachusetts Governor William Weld, and even Minnesota Governor Jesse "the Body" Ventura, have all come from a similar vein, albeit in their own ways. A variety of titles have been suggested for this movement: Clintonism, Postmaterialism, the Move to the Center, and New Fiscal Populism, to name a few. Terry Nichols Clark and Vincent Hoffmann-Martinot, editors of The New Political Culture, have compiled a series of essays that outline the tenets of the New Political Culture (their label for this phenomenon). These essays also contend that the NPC is a global trend occurring at all levels of government, from local to national.

The New Political Culture

An enormous set of statistical data has been compiled and arranged to support the propositions put forth in *The New Political Culture*, primarily gathered through the Fiscal Austerity and Urban Innovation Project (FAUI). In this study, details about the workings of thousands of city governments in over 20 countries were recorded and compared. The data were gathered over approximately fifteen years from the early 1980s into the 1990s. From their vast array of case studies, the authors have abstracted a general theory, unbound by national particulars, to describe the transformation of the political process.

The propositions posited by the book's various analysts can essentially be broken into two categories. The first is basically structural and the second, more ideological. Structurally, politics is moving away from a hierarchical and clientelistic system and towards one that is more populist and issue-oriented. Ideologically, the NPC theory suggests that the class politics model can no longer accurately describe the political forum because the classic left-right divide has been disrupted. In its place are increasing concerns for social issues and the marriage of fiscal conservatism and social liberalism. The key factor driving the emergence of the NPC is the population of younger, more affluent, more educated citizens, a population that has grown and begun to dominate the electorate.

The move away from hierarchical political organizations is driven by an increasing interest in markets and social individualism. Populations are demanding more direct control over political processes and are losing faith in the ability of distant and bloated government to effectively address national and local problems. Government has become more decentralized, and traditional welfare policies have been questioned. Issues that strike closer to home rise in importance, weakening nationwide ideological coherence and devotion to particular parties. Citizens have also turned away from conventional and hierarchical organizations towards smaller, more local, more narrowly tailored organizations. The Internet has facilitated this process by enabling people with very specific interests to connect to others who

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share those interests.

In the traditional political forum, citizens have demanded that government bureaucracy and parties accurately convey the tailored interests of the people with a minimum of waste. As a result, party and government bureaucracy is flattened, red tape and inefficiency are militantly uprooted, and clientalism, which is antithetical to efficient and effective government, is dismantled. In addition, market-oriented approaches to problem solving are rising in popularity in contrast to older central planning techniques.

Once, class politics dominated the political spectrum. In the old system, occupational class divisions corresponded to political distinctions. Economic issues, such as regulation and redistribution of wealth were more salient than social issues such as the environment, sexual education, abortion, and women's rights. Finally, social and fiscal liberalism went hand in hand.

The New Political Culture flies in the face of these old attitudes. Social issues and quality of life concerns dominate the old materialist ones. One's occupation is less deterministically related to one's political stance. Although many social outlooks require fiscal expenditure, social liberalism is increasingly married to fiscal conservatism. This is attained through increased focus on efficient government action and shrinking the government's role in certain sectors, such as welfare. Commentators have been confused by this marriage of formerly opposed social and fiscal positions. The progenitors of the New Political Culture theory suggest that this is because outdated concepts of right and left are being inappropriately applied to a new political trend.

Although the ideas presented above seem to be straightforward, the authors buried them under mountains of statistical data, acronyms, charts, graphs, and tables. Clark claims in his preface that "the book is written for social scientists as well as more general readers, including college students, elected officials, civic leaders, and interested citizens" (x). Nevertheless, it is unlikely that anyone other than a researcher with statistical training will be willing or able to pick through the generally dry and opaque style of the text. Furthermore, the authors try to locate their ideas on the academic landscape by relating each of them to various journal publications. Although this may be helpful for a few academics, it interferes with the average, even well-educated, person's reading of the text.

Moreover, although the editors present their research as a global study, it is important to note that this is not entirely the case. The countries discussed are primarily Western, either in actuality or in practice. This might be explained away by noting that the NPC appears to particularly describe democracies. However, the writers have entirely failed to mention India-the world's largest democracy, and the FAUI apparently did not study this country at all. This failure does not discredit of the NPC theory, but it must be qualified as a Western and not global phenomenon.

The book is most interesting and effective when illustrating the New Political Culture in anecdotes presented throughout, excerpted from newspapers or written by local experts. These sketches uncover how the NPC actually manifests itself in political life and also frustrate and qualify the idea that the NPC is all-pervasive. Unfortunately, these passages are isolated from the primary presentation in side-boxes in Chapter 4 and in the last three chapters of the book.

But is it Right?

The authors of *The New Political Culture* do not suggest that their model is predictive, nor do they advocate it as possessing normative value. Rather, they present empirical evidence that supports the claim that many political systems are transforming in line with many NPC propositions. If their model is accurate, and my informal observations of the political milieu suggest that it is,

The challenge facing the NPC is to reinvigorate popular interest and trust in government while not losing sight of the basic societal responsibility to the disenfranchised.

then the question arises as to whether the described situation is to be desired. The authors explicitly avoid engaging in this normative discussion, although their enthusiasm for the viability of their own models may be mistaken for an endorsement of these models. My analysis thus moves away from the book to a normative assessment of its model.

In order to evaluate a political culture, it is first necessary to outline the basic criteria for a good culture. It seems to me that the most important quality of properly functioning political processes is that they effectively translate the interests of the citizenry into policies which further those interests. This straightforward measure should also be weighted to serve first those most in need of assistance, whose basic interests are thus most pressing.

The structural developments of the NPC seem to be positive ones in light of this standard. Candidates who break down traditional hierarchies and patronage systems to speak more directly to the people are, by their nature, more responsive to citizenry concerns. The weaker party affiliations and party hierarchies in a political system are, the more effectively the views of the people are transmitted to leaders and ultimately into governmental policy. Furthermore, if party affiliation is not necessary for political viability, then it is more likely that leaders whose viewpoints are best tailored to citizenry concerns, regardless of party platforms, will be able to emerge. Therefore, an initial examination concludes that shifting away from rigid hierarchical parties and bureaucratic government is a good development.

However, the normative worth of this unalloyed political responsiveness must be questioned when following the interests of the majority results in harm to a population's most needy segment. This problem arises in the ideological developments of the NPC, which cause traditional government protection for the poor to be dismantled. This ideological position is pushed by the emergent catalyst population of the NPC: younger, more affluent, and more educated white-collar workers. Those for whom there is less immediate concern to fulfill basic needs (as is the case in this population) are likely to be critical of active government intrusion, especially in the form of redistributive taxation. Without pressing concerns that they will "just get by," this population also turns to issues that are more related to social, rather than economic, realms. These also tend to be issues that can be addressed by the government with less imposition into one's daily life and income, which is a concern of this population. This attitude is one that would appear to be fiscally conservative and socially liberal. When proponents of this position increase to a level at which they can wield significant electoral clout (as is the case under the NPC), these views take hold in government policy.

The emergence of this new, growing, professional, service-oriented middle class is one of the major outgrowths of deindustrialization. In

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this regard the NPC may be seen as the political culture of the postindustrial era. The other high growth population of our day is former blue-collar workers without marketable skills whose jobs have shifted overseas. Even in the best of economic times, like now, this population finds itself unable to procure strong jobs that provide for occupational or social advancement. The service economy that has created many high-tech, well-paying jobs has also created a demand for many low paying service jobs without possibility of advancement, like fast food employees and cleaning staff. These jobs are the most susceptible to fluctuations in the economy, but the once reliable safety net that could aid the unemployed during recessions has been largely dismantled. Parties and candidates that once served this population such as the Democrats in America or Labor in England have repositioned themselves in line with the new bourgeoisie. Lawmakers reevaluating welfare have turned enthusiastically towards the marketplace and away from programs that involve the needy becoming dependant on the government. But the market, which seems so promising to the dominant middle class, has presented increasingly fewer options to the poor. And so the postindustrial era that spawned the NPC and its ranks of supporters has also encouraged the creation of a class of economically *and* politically disenfranchised.

The individualism that spawned the NPC's ideological propositions, which weaken support for the poor, is also responsible for the structural trends of the NPC. Individualism deemphasizes one's larger societal responsibility to something other than one's own interests. The efficiency with which this individualism translates into governmental policy is heightened under the NPC because of its emphasis on political responsiveness. Hierarchy, which interferes with our first value of easy translation of popular sentiment into policy, may also shield leaders from self-interested attitudes and allow them to act with greater beneficence (of course, the opposite-the ability to act with greater malevolence-is also facilitated). Once the structural side of the NPC is reevaluated alongside its ideological implications, we see that it further weakens support of the downtrodden.

The New Political Culture, outlined by Clark and Hoffmann-Martinot, includes various positive developments. But I am critical of it insofar as the reevaluations of government that it spawns seem likely to rework governmental attitudes towards the poor that will weaken, rather than strengthen, the poor's social and political status. I am in no way suggesting that the inefficiencies and excesses of clientalism and black box party hierarchies should be retained, but I am similarly wary of a system in which leaders are made only to follow popular sentiment. The challenge facing the NPC is to reinvigorate popular interest and trust in government while not losing sight of the basic societal responsibility to the disenfranchised.

Letter from the Incoming Editor

by Josh Chafetz

I was intrigued by the fact that all three of our articles this issue were international in focus. It's not that I don't think there are plenty of interesting international issues, it's just that – well, there's so much really weird stuff going on right here. Take New York. (Please!)

There is something almost tragi-comic about the current situation in New York. The daily "protests" at Police Headquarters (this spring's Place To Be Seen) are farcical. There's something almost sadly trivializing about hundreds of celebrities, who have been good enough to provide their names to the police in advance so as to expedite processing their arrests, standing around in their nice clothes, talking on their cell-phones, waiting for their daily photo-shoot. Thoreau, Ghandhi, and King, eat your hearts out – this is what civil disobedience has become.

As the FBI investigates his department and the Governor condemns his lack of responsiveness, Police Chief Howard Safir jets to the Academy Awards and writes insipid op-eds in the *New York Times* claiming that what irks New Yorkers most about the NYPD isn't its brutality, but its "brusqueness." Fortunately, as a result of his new "Courtesy, Professionalism and Respect" campaign, NYPD officers will henceforth apologize to every unarmed citizen into whom they pump 41 bullets.

And let's talk about the Mayor. He is possibly the only person in New York less worthy of a seat in the United States Senate than Hillary Rodham Clinton (and, in her case, I use the words "in New York" loosely -- as her husband might say, it depends what the meaning of the word "in" is). Mr. Giuliani recently initiated a policy allowing the city to seize the cars of *suspected* drunk drivers, the first such policy in the nation. What if the suspects are acquitted? Then the city *might* give the cars back. That's right, *might*. Last time I checked, the Fourteenth Amendment said that states couldn't deprive any citizen of life, liberty, *or property* without due process of law. Last time I checked, the Fourteenth Amendment incorporated the Fifth Amendment's Takings Clause against the states. Mayor Giuliani needs to go back to law school.

All that's just in New York City. The list expands to racial profiling issues, school desegregation, and so much more if we expand to the Tri-State Area.

So, as *The Yale Political Quarterly* heads into it's third decade next year, we'd love to know what you think. There's plenty of interesting – and, in many cases, just plain bizarre – stuff out there in the political world. Pick something. Write about it. Let the Yale community know what's going on outside the Ivory Tower.

Josh Chafetz

"Last summer, Steven Spielberg's World War II movie was proclaimed all but certain to win best picture. It was worthy. It was good. It was dutiful. There was nothing flashy or sexy about it. It was, in short, Al Gore."

– **Maureen Dowd**, in her 24 March 1999 *New York Times* column.

"I think there's a couple of levels where it's just bizarre,"

– **Paul Boden** of the Coalition on Homelessness, on a San Francisco proposal to equip panhandlers with credit card machines. Quoted on <http://www.excite.com/>.

"To anyone who has served in Washington, there is something oddly familiar about it. First you're painted into a corner, then you're hung out to dry, and finally you're framed."

– Former Secretary of State **Warren Christopher**, on having his portrait painted. Quoted on <http://www.excite.com/>.

"The court takes no pleasure whatsoever in holding this nation's president in contempt of court."

– United States District Court Judge **Susan Webber Wright**, as quoted by the Associated Press, 12 April 1999.

SOUND BITES

"Is Clinton a Faulkner character?"

– Cover of the May 1999 issue of ***Reason Magazine***.

"A New Jersey inmate was indicted Thursday for impersonating Attorney General Janet Reno in a letter, created on a prison computer, asking for his immediate release."

– Off the Reuters wire, quoted on <http://www.excite.com/>.

"Simon & Schuster announced that Hillary Clinton – she who bridled at the term First Lady, she who bristled at the thought of staying home and baking cookies, she who preached two for the price of one, she who brazenly reverted to Rodham once the coast was clear, she who insisted on being in the West Wing with the boys, she who went boldly where no President's wife has gone before and hijacked vast precincts of social and legal policy – will produce a book on the joys of entertaining and decorating."

– **Maureen Dowd**, in her 18 April 1999 *New York Times* column.

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